

says "The export could not be performed. An error occurred while initializing MAPI". However, I can export the address book without any errors.

Sanjay Kot

A This can happen if you configure Outlook Express as the default Messaging Application Programming Interface (MAPI) client. To work around this problem, restart your computer and start Outlook Express. Go to **Tools > Options**. Under the General tab, clear the 'Make Outlook Express my default Simple MAPI client' check box and click Apply. Click OK when you receive the prompt, 'The Simple MAPI client has been changed.' You may need to restart your machine for the changes to take effect. Quit Outlook Express and restart your computer. You should now be able to import or export messages without any hassles.

Fatal exception

Q. I use an ASUS motherboard with an Athlon XP 1700+ processor, 256 MB DDR RAM and run Windows 98 SE. The problem is that while loading Windows, after POST, the system shows a blue screen with the error message 'a fatal exception OE has occurred at 017F: BFF8AB97'. Why is this so?

Babu Govindharaj K

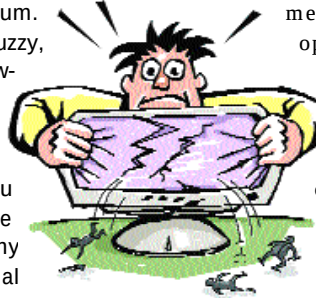
A The problem seems to lie with a memory module-timing mismatch between the RAM modules. This will mostly be the case if you use two 128 MB RAM sticks. It is also possible that the motherboard cannot detect the RAM modules settings properly. Get a BIOS update and see whether it happens again. Also, in the advanced settings of your BIOS, try setting the CPU to MEMORY ratio to 1:1, after setting all jumpers and switches back to their default values according to the motherboard manual. Change the above settings after selecting 'Load bios defaults' in the BIOS, then reboot for the changes to take effect. The problem should be solved.

If it persists, try checking the memory modules on a different PC, or a different memory slot on your machine. This would help determine whether the fault lies in the motherboard or in the DIMM slots. If the DIMM slot is faulty, then use another DIMM slot for the RAM module. In case the motherboard is defective, you will need to get it serviced by the motherboard vendor.

Oops, my display!

Q. I was playing with the display properties of my PC and set the resolution to maximum. The computer went all fuzzy, and I received the following error message—"The output signal is out of range. Please check your signal source." Could you please let me know the process of setting my PC back to its normal resolution?

Sarveh Patil



ILLUSTRATIONS: Farzana Cooper

A Boot the computer and keep [F8] pressed. You will see a Startup menu that should have an option of booting into Safe mode. Boot into Safe mode, and access the display properties by right-clicking on the desktop and choosing Properties. Set the resolution for the monitor to what it was earlier and then click on OK. Reboot the computer. This should solve the problem.

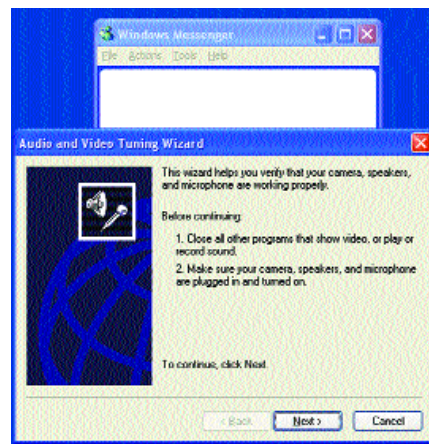
RAM compatibility

Q. I have a few questions to ask: Will a 32 MB RAM and a 128 MB RAM work together?

Secondly, I have a SIS 630 motherboard with a PIII 533 MHz processor. What is the best upgrade for this configuration?

Thirdly, how do I know whether the sound card is full duplex, or not?

Vikram Aditya Mishra



Audio tuning using MSN messenger

A Your 32 MB and 128 MB RAMs will work together, provided both of them have the same frequency, or speed ratings. The speed rating is usually printed on the RAM module itself. If they are different, set the DRAM clock to the lesser of the two, in the BIOS. The RAM speed adjustments can generally be found under the 'Advanced Chipset Settings' section. Set all the values you find there—Memory Clock, RAS\CAS Latency—to their slowest settings.

Keeping the same motherboard, the

best upgrade you can opt for is a 933 MHz PIII processor, though it is really hard to find one now since Intel has officially stopped its PIII production.

If you wish to know whether your sound card supports full duplex operation, in Windows, go to **Control Panel > Systems > Device Manager**. Here, double-click on the 'Sound Video and Game Controller' item. Select your sound card and go to Properties. In the Settings tab, look for a checkbox labelled 'Allow Full Duplex Operation'. This indicates that the sound card has the full duplexing feature.

You may also use the MSN Messenger's 'Audio Tuning Wizard' by accessing **Tools > Audio and Video Tuning Wizard** or the corresponding Yahoo! Messenger utility through **Help > Audio Setup Wizard** to check whether the sound card has a full duplexing feature.

Bad clusters

Q. I have an Intel Pentium III 866 MHz and Windows 98. In the past, I had two hard disks that developed bad clusters, which I replaced. I would like to know whether I lost those two hard disks due to non-availability of a UPS. Is it necessary to use a UPS or is a stabilizer enough? If a UPS is needed, what is the best brand?

Raghu Gadiga

A Bad clusters are actually physical damages that occur to your hard disk platters. The cause for this could be either a manufacturing defect, or a voltage fluctuation. The latter can occur if you don't have an UPS or CVT. The fluctuation may not be apparent to you, but it can still cause trouble to your hard disk. Even a troublesome SMPS can do damage. So, it is advis-